

West Point Scavenger Hunt

Long Route

Everything on the short route, plus the Cadet Chapel, Ike, Patton, and a loop around the Plain.

14 stops · about **1.7 miles** · about **145 minutes** with stops

Follow rhyming clues from Eisenhower Hall to Trophy Point. Swipe one page at a time: read the clue, walk to the next stop, then turn the page to see what you found.

Prefer tapping? Open the [interactive web version](#).

Route preview

Includes a steep climb with stairs up to the Cadet Chapel. Strollers will struggle on that stretch. Everything else is sidewalks and paths.

- 5. Start: Eisenhower Hall (park here)**
- 1. Cannons by the Firstie Club · 4 min walk**
- 2. Beat Navy Tunnel · 3 min walk**
- 3. Sylvanus Thayer Statue · 1 min walk**
- 4. Douglas MacArthur Monument · 3 min walk**
- 5. Cadet Chapel · 10 min walk**
- 6. George Washington Statue · 6 min walk**
- 7. Eisenhower & Patton Statues · 3 min walk**
- 8. Doubleday Field · 3 min walk**
- 9. The Superintendent's Review Box · 3 min walk**
- 10. Sedgwick's Lucky Spurs · 3 min walk**
- 11. Battle Monument & the Hidden Prize · 1 min walk**
- 12. The Great Chain · 3 min walk**
- 13. Hudson River Overlook · 2 min walk**
- 14. The Million-Dollar View · 4 min walk**

BEFORE YOU GO

- West Point is an active Army post. Check the current visitor access rules on westpoint.edu before you go, and bring photo ID for every adult.
- Park at Eisenhower Hall. Both routes end at Trophy Point, a short walk back to the car.
- Bring a phone with a compass app, water, and something to write with.
- There's a water fountain at Trophy Point below Battle Monument.

- Optional prize: before you start, hide a small treat in a cannon at Battle Monument.
- Please keep voices down near barracks and academic buildings when classes are in session.

STARTING POINT

Eisenhower Hall

Welcome, cadets! Your mission: follow the clues across West Point. At each stop, do the activity, answer the challenge, and learn something new. Grown-ups: tap the map links or scan the QR code to get walking directions.



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

At Eisenhower Hall? Turn the page for your first clue!

*Up the hill where the oldest cadets go to chill,
big iron friends sit perfectly still.
They used to go BOOM, now they just stay.
Find the cannons and pick your favorite
today!*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Head up the hill to the east from Eisenhower Hall toward the First Class Club. The cannons are on the lawn nearby. About 4 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 1: YOU FOUND

Cannons by the Firstie Club

ACTIVITY

Find the compass near the cannons. Which direction do the cannons point? Everybody point that way and shout it out! Then count the cannons and pick the biggest and the smallest.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

What is a “Firstie”?

Answer: A senior! West Point seniors are called First Class cadets, or “Firsties.” The First Class Club is their hangout.

FUN FACTS

- West Point has its own names for each class year: freshmen are Plebes, sophomores are Yearlings, juniors are Cows, and seniors are Firsties.
- Juniors are called “Cows” because long ago they finally got to go home on leave after two years away, “when the cows come home.”
- Captured cannons have been displayed at West Point since the Revolutionary War. The first ones were taken from the British at the Battles of Saratoga in 1777.

*Army's big rival sails out on the sea.
Go under the road for a cheer, one, two,
three!
Every Army win is painted on the wall.
Find the tunnel and give it your loudest call!*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: From the cannons, take the path south. It dips down and goes under Washington Road through the tunnel. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 2: YOU FOUND

Beat Navy Tunnel

ACTIVITY

Count how many years are painted on the walls. Then everybody yell “BEAT NAVY!” at the same time and listen for the echo.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

In what year did Army and Navy play their very first football game?

Answer: 1890, right here at West Point. Navy won that first game, so Army has been trying to beat Navy ever since!

FUN FACTS

- The Army–Navy Game is one of the oldest rivalries in college football. It is played every December.
- During the week before the game, cadets everywhere say “Beat Navy!” instead of hello.
- Army, Navy, and Air Force compete for the Commander-in-Chief’s Trophy. The President presents it to the winner.

Who made cadets do homework BEFORE class each day?

The Father of West Point, who still stands here today.

Pop out of the tunnel and climb up the stair.

A man made of bronze is waiting right there!



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Come out of the tunnel and up the stairs. Thayer's statue is just ahead, across from the Commandant's house. About 1 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 3: YOU FOUND

Sylvanus Thayer Statue

ACTIVITY

Count the buttons on Colonel Thayer's coat. Then try the Thayer Method: each kid teaches everyone else one thing they learned today.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Thayer already had a college degree when he came to West Point. How long did it take him to graduate?

Answer: About one year! He graduated from Dartmouth College in 1807, then from West Point in 1808.

FUN FACTS

- Thayer was Superintendent (the boss of West Point) from 1817 to 1833. He is called the "Father of the Military Academy."
- His idea was for cadets to study before class, then solve problems at the chalkboard in small groups. West Point still teaches this way, and it's called the Thayer Method.
- West Point was the first engineering school in America. Its graduates helped build many of the country's early roads, bridges, and railroads.
- Every year at graduation, the oldest living West Point graduate lays a wreath at this statue.

*A five-star general who loved a corncob pipe,
gave a famous speech, and it wasn't just
hype.*

Head to the barracks that carry his name.

Stone walls nearby are carved with his fame!



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Walk south on the path toward the big stone barracks. The statue and its plaza are at the north end of MacArthur Barracks, across the street from the Superintendent's house. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 4: YOU FOUND

Douglas MacArthur Monument

ACTIVITY

Who can pose exactly like MacArthur? Take a photo of everyone doing their best MacArthur. Then race to find the words “Duty, Honor, Country” carved in the stone walls.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

What three words are West Point's motto?

Answer: Duty, Honor, Country. They're carved right here, from MacArthur's famous 1962 speech to the cadets.

FUN FACTS

- MacArthur graduated first in his class in 1903. Later he came back to be West Point's Superintendent.
- He and his father, Arthur MacArthur, both earned the Medal of Honor. They were the first father and son to do it.
- He was a five-star General of the Army. That's the highest rank there is, and only five Army generals have ever held it.
- His wife, Jean, dedicated this statue in 1969.

*Look up, way up, to the castle on the hill,
with a giant pipe organ and bells that ring still.
Climb the steps, all of them, high over the
Plain.
Your legs will complain, but your eyes will
gain!*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: The chapel is the castle-like building on the hill behind the barracks. Follow the road and stairs uphill. It's steep, so take your time. About 10 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 5: YOU FOUND

Cadet Chapel

ACTIVITY

Count the steps on the way up. At the top, turn around: who can find the Plain? The Hudson River? The tall Battle Monument column? If the doors are open, peek inside and look up.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

About how many pipes does the chapel's organ have?

Answer: More than 23,000! It's one of the largest pipe organs in any church in the world. It started with about 2,400 pipes in 1911 and kept growing.

FUN FACTS

- The Cadet Chapel was finished in 1910. It's built in the Gothic style, like a medieval castle or cathedral.
- The bell tower holds twelve bells that weigh more than 14,000 pounds together. Cadets still ring them by hand.
- Many of the stained-glass windows were gifts from graduating classes.

First in war, first in peace, and first on the dollar bill.

*He's sitting on his horse and holding very still.
Out in front of the hall where cadets sit down to eat,
find the general whose horse never moves its feet.*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Head back down the hill to Washington Hall, the huge building at the south end of the Plain. Washington on horseback is out front. About 6 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 6: YOU FOUND

George Washington Statue

ACTIVITY

Look at the horse's legs. How many hooves are touching the ground? Then everyone give George your best salute.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Which general tried to hand West Point over to the British?

Answer: Benedict Arnold, in 1780. He was West Point's commander! The plot failed when the British spy John André was caught with the plans hidden in his boot.

FUN FACTS

- Washington said West Point was the most important post in America. Whoever held it controlled the Hudson River.
- Washington Hall behind the statue is the cadet dining hall. All of the roughly 4,400 cadets eat lunch there at the same time.
- This statue was dedicated in 1916. It's a copy of a famous statue of Washington in Union Square, New York City.

*He led D-Day, then was President too.
Everyone called him "Ike." Wouldn't you?
Walk along the Plain to the library tall.
Two famous generals are waiting for you all!*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Walk east along the south edge of the Plain. Ike stands near the corner of the Plain by the library, and Patton is close by. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 7: YOU FOUND

Eisenhower & Patton Statues

ACTIVITY

Take a photo with Ike. Then find General Patton nearby and look closely: what is he holding? Use your hands as pretend binoculars and scan the Plain like Patton.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

What year did Eisenhower graduate from West Point?

Answer: 1915. His class is called "the class the stars fell on" because 59 of its 164 graduates became generals.

FUN FACTS

- Ike played football for Army. In 1912 he even played against Jim Thorpe, one of the greatest athletes ever. A knee injury ended his playing, so he became a cheerleader and coach.
- In World War II he was Supreme Allied Commander and led the D-Day invasion on June 6, 1944. Later he was the 34th President of the United States.
- General Patton took five years to graduate instead of four because he had to repeat his first year. Math was hard for him!
- Cadets used to joke that Patton's statue faced the library so he could finally find it.

Peanuts, Cracker Jacks, and a diamond of green.

Its "inventor" was a cadet, or so it would seem.

Follow the edge of the Plain to the field with a backstop wall.

Batter up, Black Knights! Let's play ball!



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Keep heading east from Ike. The baseball field is just past the statues on the east side of the Plain. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 8: YOU FOUND

Doubleday Field

ACTIVITY

Open the compass on a phone. If you hit a home run right over the pitcher's head, which direction would the ball fly? Then everyone take your best home-run swing and run the bases in place.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Did Abner Doubleday really invent baseball?

Answer: Probably not! A 1907 committee gave him the credit, but historians say baseball grew out of older games like rounders. In 1839, the year he supposedly invented it, he was a cadet here at West Point.

FUN FACTS

- Abner Doubleday graduated from West Point in 1842.
- At the start of the Civil War he aimed the first Union cannon shot in defense of Fort Sumter.
- Army's baseball team plays here, with the Hudson River just beyond the outfield.

Who has the best seat when the cadets march by?

The Superintendent! Go find those stands nearby.

Look across the Plain, all grassy and wide. Barracks and a giant mess hall line every side!



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Walk north along the east edge of the Plain. The Review Box is the set of stands facing the parade field. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 9: YOU FOUND

The Superintendent's Review Box

ACTIVITY

Look across the Plain to Washington Hall in the middle and the barracks on each side. If you lived on the top floor, how many flights of stairs would you climb? Then march 20 steps together in a parade: left, right, left!

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Spot the sports field to the north with H-shaped posts. Which sport is it for?

Answer: Rugby! Rugby goals are H-shaped. That's Dally Field, where Army also plays lacrosse.

FUN FACTS

- The Plain is West Point's parade field. Soldiers of the Continental Army drilled and camped here during the Revolutionary War.
- A parade where a leader watches the cadets march past is called a "review."
- The Superintendent is the head of West Point. The job is held by a three-star general.
- The whole Corps of Cadets, about 4,400 people, can march onto the Plain together.

*Need a little luck before a big test?
Spin a general's spurs. Cadets say it works
best!*

*Follow the Plain's edge to where "Uncle
John" stands,
and give his boot wheels a spin with your
hands.*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Keep going north along the Plain toward Trophy Point. Sedgwick stands near Washington Road, across from the tall Battle Monument. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

Sedgwick's Lucky Spurs

ACTIVITY

Find the spurs on Sedgwick's boots. Do they really spin?
Give them a gentle spin and make a wish for your next test.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Why do cadets spin Sedgwick's spurs?

Answer: For luck! Legend says a cadet about to fail should spin the spurs at midnight before the final exam, wearing full dress uniform, and they'll pass.

FUN FACTS

- General John Sedgwick's soldiers loved him so much they called him "Uncle John." They paid for this statue themselves in 1868.
- He was the highest-ranking Union officer killed in the Civil War, at the Battle of Spotsylvania in 1864.
- In 2024 the statue was cleaned and the spurs were repaired so they would keep spinning, a gift from the West Point Class of 1978.
- Look nearby on the Plain for a newer statue of Ulysses S. Grant, added in 2019.

*A super-tall column as smooth as can be,
with a winged lady on top for all to see.
Big stone balls and old cannons stand guard
on the ground.
Peek inside the cannons. Is there treasure to
be found?*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Cross Washington Road carefully, holding hands, to the tall column. About 1 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

Battle Monument & the Hidden Prize

ACTIVITY

Peek inside the cannons around the monument. Did somebody leave a prize? Then take a picture with the big granite balls. Can your family link arms all the way around one? Look up: who can see the statue on the very top?

CHALLENGE QUESTION

The statue on top is named after a word that means being very well known. What's her name?

Answer: Fame! She was sculpted by Frederick MacMonnies.

FUN FACTS

- The column is 46 feet tall and made of one polished piece of granite. It's believed to be one of the largest polished granite columns in the Western Hemisphere.
- It honors the 2,230 Regular Army soldiers and officers who died for the Union in the Civil War. Their names are carved here.
- Soldiers paid for it by giving a little bit of their pay. It was dedicated in 1897.

Grown-up tip: Want a prize moment? Before you start, hide a small treat in the mouth of one of the cannons here and tell the kids to check inside.

*To stop British ships from sailing upriver,
they stretched something across that would
make captains shiver.*

*Each link weighs as much as a grown-up,
maybe more!*

Find the giant chain near the river's shore.



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Head northeast across Trophy Point toward the river.
The chain links are on the east end. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

The Great Chain

ACTIVITY

Measure one link with your hands. How many hands long is it? Then lie down next to the chain: how many kids long is the whole thing?

CHALLENGE QUESTION

The chain was made of heavy iron. How did it stay on top of the water?

Answer: It was attached to big floating logs, like rafts, all the way across the river.

FUN FACTS

- In 1778, soldiers stretched the Great Chain across the Hudson River from West Point to Constitution Island. That's the island you can see across the water.
- Each link is about 2 feet long and weighs over 100 pounds. The whole chain was about a third of a mile long.
- It was taken out every winter so the river ice wouldn't wreck it, then put back every spring.
- The British never tried to break through it.

*Barges and tugboats and sailboats too
chug up the Hudson. How many can you
view?*

*Just below the chain there's a spot by the rail.
Be the lookout and spot a boat or a sail!*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Just below the chain is a small overlook by the railing.
Hold hands, because there's a drop-off. About 2 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

Hudson River Overlook

ACTIVITY

Be the lookout! Count every boat you can see. Which way is each one going? Look at the water too: is it flowing left or right right now?

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Which way does the Hudson River flow?

Answer: Both ways! The ocean's tides push all the way up past West Point, so the water flows north for a few hours, then south. A Native American name for the river means "the river that flows both ways."

FUN FACTS

- The water near West Point is the deepest part of the Hudson, about 200 feet deep. Sailors called it "World's End" because of its tricky winds and currents.
- The river makes a sharp S-shaped bend here. Old sailing ships had to slow down to turn, which made them easy targets for cannons. That's why West Point was so important.

You made it to the end, and the view is the prize!

Find the big grassy hill that will open your eyes.

Look north up the river past mountains so grand.

It's the million-dollar view, the best in the land!



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Walk back toward Battle Monument and look north over the grassy hill and the amphitheater. About 4 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

The Million-Dollar View

ACTIVITY

BONUS ROUND! (1) Take a drink from the water fountain below Battle Monument. (2) Roll or run down the hill, but be careful, it's steeper than it looks! (3) Take a family photo with the million-dollar view. Last of all, everyone shares their favorite stop.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Looking up the river, what is the big mountain on the left?

Answer: Storm King Mountain. Across the river on the right is Breakneck Ridge.

FUN FACTS

- Trophy Point is named for the captured cannons, or “trophies,” displayed here. They come from five different wars.
- Painters from the Hudson River School, a famous group of American artists in the 1800s, came here to paint this view.
- In the summer, the West Point Band plays concerts in the amphitheater below the hill.



Mission complete!

You finished the Long Route: 14 stops and about 1.7 miles.
Every cadet earns an honorary Black Knight salute. Hooah!